

Montreal AI x Law Hackathon 2026

Official Rule Book

1. Event Overview

This is a 10-hour, in-person hackathon focused on building AI-powered solutions for the legal industry. Teams will compete in one of three sponsor-defined challenge tracks, with the opportunity to win both a sponsor track prize and a place in the overall top 3.

2. Schedule

Time	What's Happening
8:00 AM	Doors open, registration & check-in
8:30 AM	Kickoff begins; sponsors present challenges
9:00 AM	Team spreadsheet locks; hacking begins
9:00 - 9:15 AM	Teams discuss and pick their challenge
9:15 AM	Track selection sheet opens
10:00 AM	Track selection closes
5:00 PM	Pitch order and judging schedule released
7:00 PM	Hacking ends; submissions due (hard deadline)
7:00 – 10:00 PM	Judging (challenge tracks + final round); announcement of prizes

3. Eligibility

- Open to anyone 18 years of age or older.
- All hacking must be done on-site for the duration of the event.
- Food, snacks, and coffee are provided throughout the day.

4. Teams

- Maximum 5 members per team. There is no minimum — solo participants are welcome.
- Teams must be entered into the team spreadsheet by **9:00 AM sharp** on the day of the event.
- After 9:00 AM, no new teams may be created and team rosters cannot be changed.

- One designated member per team is responsible for submitting the team's entries to the team spreadsheet, the track selection sheet, and the final submission form.

5. Sponsored Challenge Tracks

- Three sponsored challenge tracks are available, each themed around a specific legal AI challenge presented at the 8:30 AM kickoff.
- Every team must register for exactly one challenge track.
- From **9:00 to 9:15 AM**, teams discuss and decide on their challenge track together.
- Track registration is **first-come, first-served** via the track selection sheet. The sheet opens at **9:15 AM** and closes at **10:00 AM**.
- Each track is capped at **one third of total teams** (i.e. 1/3, 1/3, 1/3) to ensure balanced participation. Once a track reaches capacity, it is closed and remaining teams must select from the available challenge tracks.
- Teams that have not registered for a track by 10:00 AM will be assigned to the track with the most remaining capacity.

When registering on the track selection sheet, the designated team member must provide:

- Team number
- Team name
- Designated member's email
- Designated member's Discord contact
- Selected challenge

6. Competition Format

- Every team competes in **both** their sponsored challenge track AND for the overall top 3.
- A single submission is used for both judging rounds.
- Prizes stack: a team can win their sponsor track *and* place in the overall top 3.

7. Resources Provided

Google Cloud credits are provided to all participating teams to support their builds. Teams are strongly encouraged to use Google platforms (Vertex AI, Gemini API, Google Cloud, etc.), though their use is not required.

Instructions on how to access these credits will be available on the Google Drive shared with participants. Other tools, datasets, and APIs provided by track sponsors will be communicated during the 8:30 AM kickoff.

The use of open-source tools is also permitted and encouraged.

8. Rules of Play

Allowed

- Open-source libraries, frameworks, and APIs.
- AI coding assistants.
- LLMs to assist with pitch decks, written submissions, and other content.
- Advice and debugging help from sponsors, mentors, and other organizers.

Not Allowed

- **Pre-existing project code or work started before the hackathon.** All project work must be built during the 10-hour hacking window (9:00 AM – 7:00 PM).
- Anyone outside the team writing code or producing content on behalf of the team.
- Working off-site during hacking hours.
- **Live-streaming the event** (on Twitch, YouTube, social media, or any other platform). This includes streaming pitches, judging sessions, or general event activity.

Intellectual Property

Teams retain full intellectual property rights to anything they build. Sponsors do not acquire any IP rights through participation in the hackathon.

9. Submissions

- **Deadline:** 7:00 PM sharp — hard cutoff, no exceptions.
- No code commits accepted after 7:00 PM. Judges may verify via Git timestamps.
- Submissions are made via a single Google Form. One submission per team.

Required submission contents:

- Team name.
- Team number.
- Names of all team members.
- Short project description.
- Link to project (if available).
- Demo video (optional).

Per-member consent (collected for each team member in the form):

- Consent to photographs of the participant being shared on social media by organizers and sponsors.
- Consent to the participant's contact information being shared with sponsors after the hackathon for recruitment purposes.

10. Judging Rubric

All judging is based on the following four criteria:

Criterion	What we're looking for
Innovation & Creativity	How unique and creative is the solution? Does it tackle the legal problem in a new way?
Technical Execution	Does the prototype and its features work as intended?
AI Utilization	How effectively did the team integrate and use AI to solve the legal problem?
Presentation & Pitch	How clearly did the team articulate their problem, solution, and value?

11. Judging Methodology

- Each judge scores each team on each of the 4 criteria, on a scale of 1 to 5.
- The four scores are summed to produce that judge's score for the team (out of 20). *All criteria are weighted equally — no further multiplier is applied.*
- Each judge's scores are converted into a personal ranking of teams (highest scoring team = rank 1, second highest = rank 2, etc.).
- Rankings from all judges are summed across teams. **The team with the lowest rank sum wins.**

12. Round 1 — Sponsored Challenge Track Judging

- Each track is judged separately by judges from that track's sponsor organization.
- Each team gives a **3-minute pitch + 2-minute Q&A** (5 minutes total). Time limits are hard stops.
- Pitch order and the full judging schedule will be released at **5:00 PM**.
- Teams must have their demo ready before their slot. A backup demo video is strongly recommended in case of technical failure.
- Judges score using the methodology in Section 11. The team with the **lowest rank sum wins the sponsor track**.
- The **top 2 teams from each track** advance to the finals (6 finalists total).

13. Round 2 — Finals

- The 6 finalist teams pitch on the main stage in front of all attendees.
- Each team gives a **5-minute pitch + 5-minute Q&A** (10 minutes total). Time limits are hard stops.
- Teams may use the same pitch from Round 1; no new content is required.
- The finals panel consists of **7 to 10 judges** representing event sponsors.

- Judges score using the methodology in Section 11. The **3 lowest rank sums** are the overall top 3, in order.

14. Tiebreakers

In the event of tied rank sums, ties are resolved in this order, for both Round 1 and 2:

1. The team with more first-place rankings wins.
2. If still tied, judges briefly re-deliberate and re-rank only the tied teams.

15. Prizes

Award	Amount
1st place (overall)	\$3,500
2nd place (overall)	\$2,500
3rd place (overall)	\$1,500
1st place (per challenge track) or special award (per award)	\$500

16. Disqualification

A team may be disqualified for any of the following:

- Late submission (any submission after 7:00 PM).
- Code commits after the 7:00 PM submission deadline.
- Team exceeding 5 members.
- Plagiarism or submitting pre-existing project work as new.
- Working off-site during hacking hours.
- Live-streaming the event.
- Violations of the Code of Conduct.

17. Code of Conduct

All participants, sponsors, judges, and organizers are expected to treat each other with respect and professionalism. Harassment, discrimination, or disruptive behavior of any kind will not be tolerated and may result in removal from the event without prize eligibility.

If you experience or witness behavior that violates this code, please notify an organizer immediately.

Good luck, and happy hacking!